DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Student Details

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Introduction

This project was assigned as part of the Digital Literacy course, where I was given the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. The objective of this project was to explore how digital tools are used in academic and professional environments and to understand how to use them responsibly.

The project includes five tasks, each focusing on a different aspect of digital literacy such as awareness, digital presence, collaboration tools, communication etiquette, and cyber safety. Through these activities, I gained practical experience using different platforms and learned how digital behaviour can impact academic performance and future opportunities. This project helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about using tools but also about using them carefully, ethically, and effectively.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I created a digital literacy infographic using Canva to explain key concepts in a simple and visually clear way. The infographic includes important topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, commonly used digital tools, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette.

While designing the infographic, I focused on presenting information in a concise and easy-to-understand format. I used bullet points instead of long paragraphs so that viewers can quickly grasp the main ideas. I also selected a clean layout and consistent colour scheme to make the design visually appealing and readable. Canva made it easier to organise content and experiment with different design elements such as icons and text alignment.

One challenge I faced was fitting multiple topics into a single page without making the design look crowded. This required careful selection of content and prioritising the most relevant points. Overall, this task helped me understand that effective communication in digital formats requires both clarity and simplicity.

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created and updated my digital presence across three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are important for building a professional identity and showcasing skills in the digital world.

On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my academic details, interests, and learning goals. This acts as an introduction for anyone viewing my profile. On LinkedIn, I added my education details, including my degree, university, and expected graduation year, which helps in building a professional network. I also created a Kaggle account to explore data science and practice-based learning opportunities.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms by adding projects, improving my skills, and maintaining an updated profile. This will help me build a strong digital portfolio that reflects my growth. This task helped me realise that maintaining an authentic and consistent online presence is important for future academic and career opportunities.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this task, I explored both coding practice platforms and collaboration tools. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level problem called “Solve Me First.” This helped me understand how coding platforms work and how problems are structured. It also introduced me to basic programming logic and problem-solving techniques.

In addition, I created a Google Form titled “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” with five questions related to digital literacy and safe internet practices. The form includes both multiple-choice and short-answer questions. I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to view and manage responses.

These platforms are useful for academic purposes because coding platforms help improve logical thinking and programming skills, while tools like Google Forms can be used for surveys, quizzes, and collecting data efficiently. This task helped me understand the importance of combining technical skills with practical tools for better learning and collaboration.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette

In this task, I drafted two professional emails — one to a professor requesting an assignment extension and another to an internship coordinator expressing interest in an internship opportunity. I ensured that both emails followed proper structure, including clear subject lines, polite greetings, well-organised content, and professional sign-offs.

I also created a checklist of social media do’s and don’ts to promote responsible digital behaviour among students.

A common issue in digital communication is sending informal or unclear messages in professional situations. For example, writing emails without proper structure or tone can create a negative impression. This problem can be avoided by following basic email etiquette and maintaining a respectful and clear communication style.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

For this task, I researched phishing as a type of cybercrime and created a case study explaining how it works, who is targeted, and what consequences it can have. Phishing attacks often involve fake emails or links that trick users into sharing personal or financial information.

I also created a prevention checklist with practical tips such as avoiding suspicious links, protecting personal information, and using secure passwords. The checklist also included cybercrime reporting details such as the National Cyber Crime Portal and helpline number.

What surprised me the most was how easily people can be tricked by messages that appear genuine. This made me realise the importance of being cautious while using digital platforms. One habit I plan to change is verifying links and messages before responding.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about using digital tools, but also about using them responsibly, safely, and professionally. I learned how to build a digital presence, communicate effectively, and protect myself from cyber threats. These skills will be useful throughout my academic journey and future career. Overall, this project provided practical knowledge and helped me become more aware of my digital behaviour.

References

- Canva (canva.com)
- GitHub (github.com)
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com)
- HackerRank (hackerrank.com)
- Google Forms (forms.google.com)
- National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)